

Prevention of Sexual Harassment in Workplace

Goal: Healthy Work Environment

Purpose: Workplace Harassment Awareness

Scope: Employees of Novigo

Version Details:

Sl. No.	Date	Version	Updated By	Approved By	Description
1	25 January 2016	1.0	Sandeep Rao	Praveen Kumar Kalbhavi	First Version
2	30 April 2017	1.1	Laneza Lobo	Praveen Kumar Kalbhavi	Change in Committee Member
3	19 February 2020	1.2	Sandeep Rao	Praveen Kumar Kalbhavi	Change in Committee Member
4	05 September 2022	1.3	Diana Bangera	Praveen Kumar Kalbhavi	Change in Committee Member
5	25 September 2024	1.4	Diana Bangera	Praveen Kumar Kalbhavi	Change in Committee Member

Commitment:

Novigo Solutions is committed to creating a healthy work environment that enables employees to work without fear of prejudice, gender bias and ensures harassment-free workplace to all employees without regard to race, caste, religion, color, ancestry, marital status, gender, sexual orientation, age, nationality, ethnic region or disability. Novigo Solutions will not tolerate any form of sexual harassment and is committed to take all necessary steps to ensure that its employees are not subjected to any form of harassment.

Definition of Sexual Harassment:

Sexual harassment may be one or a series of incidents involving unsolicited and unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favour, or any other verbal or physical conduct of sexual nature.

Sexual Harassment at the workplace includes:

- Unwelcome sexual advances (verbal, written or physical)
- Demand or request for sexual favour
- Any other type of sexually oriented conduct
- Verbal abuse or 'joking' that is sex-oriented,
- Any conduct that has the purpose or the effect of interfering with an individual's work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile or offensive work environment and/or submission to such conduct is either an explicit or implicit term or condition of employment and /or submission or rejection of the conduct is used as a basis for making employment decisions.

Responsibilities Regarding Sexual Harassment:

All employees of the Company have a personal responsibility to ensure that their behaviour is not contrary to this policy. All employees are encouraged to reinforce the maintenance of a work environment free from sexual harassment.

Complaints Committee:

The Company has instituted a Complaints Committee to address sexual harassment complaint (made by the victim) and for ensuring time bound treatment of such complaints. Initially, and till further notice, the Complaints Committee will comprise of the following seven members:

1. Madhumita Kumari –Recruitment Manager (Presiding Officer)
2. Pavan Rai – Senior HR Manager (Member)
3. Diana Sushma Bangera – Associate Lead HRBP(Member)
4. Vichelle Monteiro – Senior HRBP(Member)
5. Shamaprasad C.G – Senior Project Manager(Member)
6. Trishla Singh – Corporate Lawyer (Member)
7. Uttam Kumar Rai A – BA, LLB (Advocate- External Member)

Procedures for Resolution, Settlement or Prosecution Of Acts Of Sexual Harassment:

Novigo Solutions is committed to providing a supportive environment to resolve concerns of sexual harassment as under:

• Informal Resolution Options:

When an incident of sexual harassment occurs, the victim of such conduct can communicate their disapproval and objections immediately to the harasser and request the harasser to behave decently. If the harassment does not stop or if victim is not comfortable with addressing the harasser directly, the victim can bring their concern to the attention of the Complaints Committee. The Complaints Committee will thereafter provide advice or extend support as requested and will undertake a prompt investigation to resolve the matter.

Complaints:

- An employee with a harassment concern, who is not comfortable with the informal resolution options or has exhausted such options, may make a formal complaint to the Complaints Committee constituted by the Management. The complaint shall have to be in writing and can be in the form of a letter, preferably within 15 days from the date of occurrence of the alleged incident, sent in a sealed envelope. Alternatively, the employee can send complaint through an email. The employee is required to disclose their name, department, division and location they are working in, to enable the Presiding Officer to contact them and take the matter forward. Email ID: - hr@novigosolutions.com
- The Presiding Officer of the Complaints Committee will proceed to determine whether the allegations (assuming them to be true only for the purpose of this determination) made in the complaint fall under the purview of Sexual Harassment, preferably within 30 days from receipt of the complaint. In the event, the allegation does not fall under the purview of Sexual Harassment, or the allegation does not constitute an offence of Sexual Harassment, the Presiding Officer will record this finding with reasons and communicate the same to the complainant.
- If the Presiding Officer of the Complaints Committee determines that the allegations constitute an act of sexual harassment, the Presiding officer will proceed to investigate the allegation with the assistance of the Complaints Committee.
- Where such conduct, on the part of the accused, amounts to a specific offence under the law, the Company shall initiate appropriate action in accordance with law by making a complaint with the appropriate authority.
- The Complaints Committee shall conduct such investigations in a timely manner and shall submit a written report containing the findings and recommendations to the Presiding Officer as soon as practically possible and in any case, not later than 60 days from the date of receipt of the complaint. The Presiding officer will ensure corrective action on the recommendations of the Complaints Committee and keep the complainant informed of the same.

Corrective action may include any of the following:

- Formal apology
- Counselling
- Written warning to the perpetrator and a copy of it maintained in the employee's file.
- Change of work assignment / transfer for either the perpetrator or the victim.
- Suspension or termination of services of the employee found guilty of the offence
- In case the complaint is found to be false, the Complainant shall, if deemed fit, be liable for appropriate disciplinary action by the Management.

Confidentiality:

The Company understands that it is difficult for the victim to come forward with a complaint of sexual harassment and recognizes the victim's interest in keeping the matter confidential. To protect the interests of the victim, the accused person and others who may report incidents of sexual harassment, confidentiality will be maintained throughout the investigatory process to the extent practicable and appropriate under the circumstances.

Access to Reports and Documents:

All records of complaints, including contents of meetings, results of investigations and other relevant material will be kept confidential by the Company except where disclosure is required under disciplinary or other remedial processes.

Protection to Complainant / Victim:

The Company is committed to ensuring that no employee who brings forward a harassment concern is subject to any form of reprisal. Any reprisal will be subject to disciplinary action.

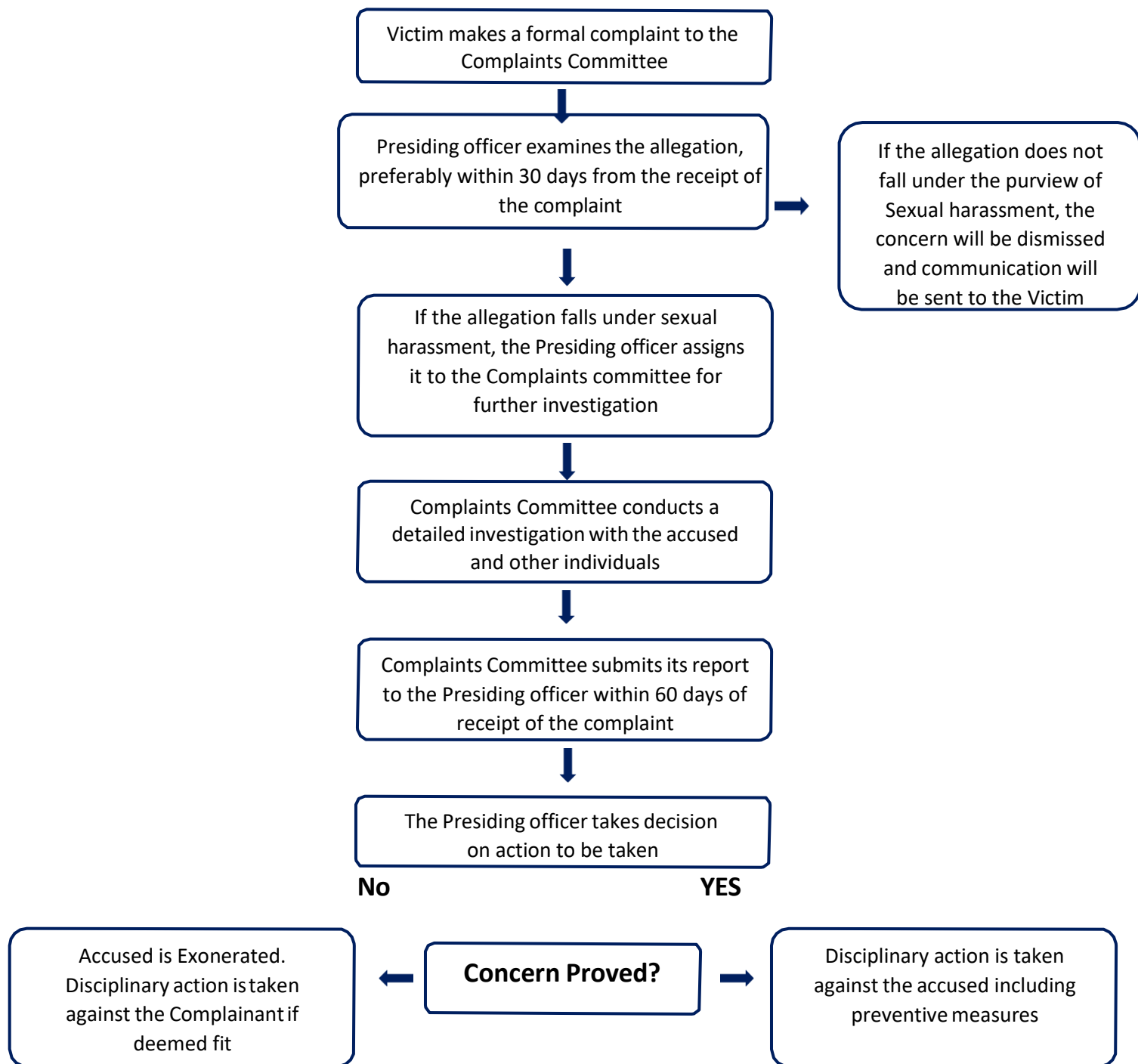
The Company will ensure that the victim or witnesses are not victimized or discriminated against while dealing with complaints of sexual harassment.

However, anyone who abuses the procedure (for example, by maliciously putting an allegation knowing it to be untrue) will be subject to disciplinary action.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, the Company reiterates its commitment to providing its employees, a workplace free from harassment/ discrimination and where every employee is treated with dignity and respect.

Process Flow:



Any exceptions to be reviewed and approved by the CEO.



Praveen Kumar Kalbhavi
MD/CEO